

PayTracka — Product Requirements Document (PRD)

Version 1.0 | MVP Buildathon Submission

1. Executive Summary

PayTracka is a mobile application designed for African freelancers to track invoices, monitor payments, and manage cash flow in one place.

Freelancers often receive income from multiple platforms such as Upwork, Payoneer, and direct bank transfers. This fragmented system makes it difficult to track earnings, leading to missed payments, delayed follow-ups, and poor financial planning.

PayTracka solves this by providing:

- A unified income view
- A “Who Owes Me” tracker
- One-tap payment reminders
- Cash-flow insights

The MVP focuses on tracking and follow-up, not moving money.

MVP Goal:

Deliver a functional app tested by at least 10 freelancers, with a satisfaction rating of $\geq 4/5$ on solving their payment tracking challenges.

2. Problem Statement

Freelancers across Africa face consistent challenges in managing their payments:

- Income is fragmented across multiple platforms, making it difficult to track total earnings.
- Payments are often delayed (average ~41 days), disrupting cash flow.
- Invoice tracking is manual or inconsistent, leading to missed or duplicated follow-ups.
- Freelancers spend 5–10 hours monthly chasing payments.
- There is no simple tool to forecast incoming income.

These challenges result in lost income, financial stress, and reduced productivity.

3. Product Vision and Goals

Vision

To become the financial control center for African freelancers, providing instant visibility into who owes them, how much, and when to follow up.

Core Product Principles

- Simplicity first – fast, intuitive, mobile-first experience
- Daily habit product – users should open it every day
- No payment complexity in MVP – focus on tracking and reminders
- Low-data, low-device optimization

Key Goals

- Provide a single view of all income (pending and received)
- Enable users to create and track invoices in under 30 seconds
- Reduce time spent chasing payments through automated reminders
- Offer clear cash-flow visibility at a glance
- Support faster payments via payment links

4. Target Users

Primary Users

- Freelancers working across multiple platforms
- Remote workers handling international clients
- Side-hustlers managing small but frequent invoices

User Needs

- Simplicity (no spreadsheets)
- Visibility (what's owed and when)
- Speed (quick actions, minimal setup)
- Reliability (accurate tracking and reminders)

5. MVP Scope

The MVP is designed for a 7-day build sprint with strict scope control.

In Scope

1. Onboarding & Unified Inbox

- Sign up via Google or phone
- Add or simulate payment sources
- View all transactions in one feed

2. Who Owes Me + Reminders

- Create invoices

- View invoices by urgency (Overdue, Due Soon, Paid)
- Send reminder messages via WhatsApp, SMS, or email
- Generate payment links

3. Insights Dashboard

- View expected income
- Track overdue payments
- Identify high-risk clients
- Basic income trends and projections

Out of Scope (Future Versions)

- Direct money transfers
- Full platform integrations (Upwork, PayPal, etc.)
- Advanced AI predictions
- Tax/accounting features
- Multi-currency live conversion

6. Key Features Overview

1. Unified Inbox

A single feed displaying all transactions across platforms.

Key Capabilities:

- Combined view of all income sources
- Status indicators (pending, paid)
- Offline access to cached data

2. Who Owes Me Tracker

A visual system that helps users prioritize follow-ups.

Key Capabilities:

- Kanban-style layout:
- Overdue
- Due Soon
- Paid
- Urgency-based sorting
- Quick invoice creation

3. Smart Reminders

Automated and manual follow-up system.

Key Capabilities:

- Pre-written reminder messages
- Multi-channel sharing (WhatsApp, SMS, Email)
- “Remind All” feature
- Custom reminder rules per client

4. Payment Links

Allows clients to pay directly via generated links.

Key Capabilities:

- Link generation per invoice
- Easy sharing
- Automatic status update upon payment

5. Insights Dashboard

Provides a clear financial overview.

Key Capabilities:

- Expected income (next 14 days)
- Overdue totals
- Client reliability indicators
- Monthly income trends
- Basic “what-if” simulations

6. User Flow (Core Journey)

1. User signs up
2. Adds a payment source
3. Creates an invoice
4. Generates a payment link
5. Shares the link with the client
6. Client completes payment
7. Invoice updates to “Paid”
8. Insights dashboard reflects updated data

7. Key Screens

The MVP consists of five primary screens:

- Onboarding Screen – quick sign-up
- Home Dashboard – summary of financial status
- Unified Inbox – all transactions
- Who Owes Me – invoice tracking and reminders
- Insights Dashboard – financial overview

8. Technical Overview

- Frontend: Flutter (Android-first)
- Backend: Node.js + FastAPI
- Database: Firebase Firestore
- Authentication: Firebase Auth
- Notifications: Firebase Cloud Messaging
- Payments: Interswitch API

The system supports offline functionality through local caching.

9. Non-Functional Requirements

- App loads within 2 seconds on low-data networks
- Fully usable offline with cached data
- Works on low-end Android devices (2GB RAM)
- Secure payment verification (server-side)
- Clear, user-friendly error messages

10. Success Metrics

The MVP will be considered successful if:

- 10 users complete the test flow
- User satisfaction score $\geq$ %
- App performs reliably on low-end devices
- Core flow (invoice → reminder → payment) works end-to-end
- No scope creep beyond defined features

11. Future Enhancements

- Automatic transaction imports
- Full platform integrations
- Advanced analytics and forecasting
- Machine learning-based payment predictions

- Multi-currency support with live exchange rates

12. Feature Prioritization / Scope justification

The MVP scope was defined based on delivering maximum user value within a 7-day build timeline.

Included Features (Why)

- Who Owes Me Tracker → Core daily pain point
- Smart Reminders → Directly reduces time spent chasing payments
- Unified Inbox → Eliminates fragmented income tracking
- Insights Dashboard → Enables quick financial understanding

Excluded Features (Why)

- Direct payments → High technical and regulatory complexity
- Platform integrations → Requires external dependencies and time
- Advanced analytics/ML → Not required to validate core value
- Multi-currency live conversion → Adds complexity without core impact

Prioritization Principle:

Focus on tracking + follow-up, which delivers immediate value and validates the product before expanding scope.

13. Assumptions & Risks

Key Assumptions

- Freelancers are willing to manually input invoices in exchange for better tracking
- WhatsApp is the preferred channel for payment reminders
- Users will check the app frequently (daily or near-daily)
- Basic rule-based insights are sufficient for MVP value

Key Risks

- Manual data entry may feel time-consuming
- Payment API (Interswitch) may fail or be unstable
- Users may not trust generated payment links
- Low initial engagement if habit is not formed

Mitigation Strategies

- Optimize invoice entry to under 30 seconds
- Implement retry and fallback messaging for failed API calls
- Use clear, transparent messaging around payments
- Design for daily habit (simple, fast, actionable UI)

14. Conclusion

PayTracka addresses a critical gap in the African freelance economy by simplifying how payments are tracked and managed.

By focusing on clarity, speed, and daily usability, the MVP aims to become a tool freelancers rely on every day — reducing financial uncertainty and improving income visibility.